

The purpose of this research is to better understand the types of psychosocial and socioeconomic circumstances that people discuss when seeking information, advice, or support from large language models (LLMs). We are conducting this study to develop a high-quality human-annotated dataset that can be used to better understand help-seeking behavior in human–AI interactions and to evaluate the ability of AI systems to identify these circumstances.

As part of this study, you will be asked to review de-identified user messages from a publicly available dataset of human–LLM conversations. Using a provided annotation guide, you will identify and categorize the types of life circumstances or problems described in each message. Examples may include educational, occupational, economic, housing, interpersonal, social, legal, health-related, or other psychosocial circumstances. You may also provide optional notes explaining your reasoning for difficult or ambiguous cases.

The annotation task is expected to take approximately 2–3 hours to complete and may be completed remotely and asynchronously.

The potential risks to participants are minimal. Some messages may contain sensitive or potentially distressing content, including discussions of relationship difficulties, abuse, trauma, mental health concerns, self-harm, suicide, grief, financial hardship, or other difficult life circumstances. Participation is voluntary, and you may discontinue participation at any time without penalty. If you experience distress and would like support, resources are available through SafeUT (<https://safeut.org/>).

Results may be reported in publications or presentations, but no identifying information about participants will be disclosed.

If you have any questions, complaints, or concerns about this research, please contact:

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Contact the Institutional Review Board (IRB) if you have questions about your rights as a research participant. You may also contact the IRB if you have questions, complaints, or concerns that you do not feel comfortable discussing with the investigators. The University of Utah IRB may be reached by e-mail at irb@hsc.utah.edu.

Participation in this study is voluntary. You may choose to withdraw from the study at any time without penalty.

By proceeding with the annotation task, you are indicating your consent to participate in this research study.

Thank you for your participation.